



The biggest advantage of 'e-Administration' is that it enables us to view, at any stage, the status of a pending file

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e-Administration is the brainchild of ICT specialist, VDG Krishnan, founder president, LL2B.com Pvt Ltd. He has 25 years of managerial experience and has worked in the Indian public sector as well as in a leading MNC based in the Americas. He intended to develop a simple yet effective solution, to enable governments, corporates, SMEs and NGOs implement e-governance, in developing countries such as India.

e-Administration is a Web-enabled, platform-independent, paperless solution developed on an Open Source platform, for paperless communication within and outside an organisation. It uses offerings such as J2EE, JBOSS and PGSQL.

The tool, according to Krishnan, has reduced the file approval cycle from an average of two to three weeks to one week. This has also resulted in considerable reduction of paper-usage within an organisation. (See the Digit DVD for a presentation on LL2B's e-administration tool)

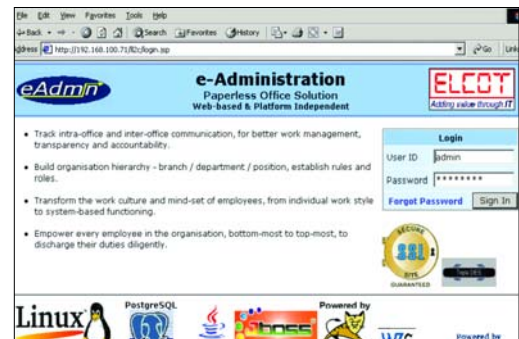
Krishnan says LL2B's tool empowers every employee in the organisation to discharge his or her duties efficiently. Dependencies on subordinates has also reduced and the organisation is now more system-oriented than people-centric. This is likely to result in increased productivity. Its Linux platform also makes it easy to add local language content.

Any organisation that deals with multiple agencies can use this tool for a simultaneous review-and-action process. e-Administration also aids knowledge management and integration in NGOs, self-assessment, decentralised field updating and centralised review and monitoring.

The Process Involved

ELCOT conducted trials with products offered by three SMEs—for independent evaluation, with a view to adopt the best tool. The SMEs were asked to implement the necessary customisations, to suit the requirements of ELCOT.

Trials were conducted over three months, with equal opportunity given to all solutions. For the purpose of testing, each department had a system configured as the server and five



The e-Administration tool is accessed via a browser

nodes (on an average) connected to it as clients.

Says K Appuswamy, general manager (e-Governance), "Many organisations conducted trials but only LL2B's model worked successfully at ELCOT."

LL2B.com's product was one of the three LAN based solutions tried out—the front-end was based on Visual Basic while Microsoft Access running on a Microsoft Windows 2000 server was used as the back-end. This tool was initially installed in ELCOT's marketing department for about five officers. Seeing its efficiency, other officers and staff voluntarily came forward to use the tool. Once the number of users increased, the solution was upgraded to a browser-based Web version to eliminate the dependency that existed on client systems.

Currently, e-Administration connects about 150 users, in three different locations across 25 km, including ELCOT's corporate office at Nandanam, their communication division at Perungudy, and ELCOT Chairman Vivek Harinarain, who is also IT Secretary, Govt of Tamil Nadu, at the Secretariat, through a dedicated powerful four-way Xeon dual processor with RAID facility, running a versatile Oracle 9i database as backend, on a Linux-based advanced server, centrally located at the corporate office.

The tool simplified the process of generating files and enabled moving note sheets electronically: instead of physically carrying



Why ELCOT took the plunge

- ❑ The number of major departments: 4
 - ❑ The average number of files generated per department per year: 150
 - ❑ The average number of note movements (cycles) per file: 20
 - ❑ The average time taken to generate a note and get approval - 4 to 6 days
 - ❑ The average number of physical movement for each cycle: 8
- The total number of manual entries / file movement from desk-to-desk per year: $4 \times 150 \times 20 \times 8 = 96,000$ manual entries or file movements per year.

The workload is not evenly distributed as it depends on a hierarchy to grant sanction and/or approve files. The Managing Director (MD) typically has to view and approve approximately 200 files per week. That is an average of 40 files per working day! This is apart from the various meetings he has to attend. Files pile up when he is on tour

and he is forced to carry work home. Files are kept pending while the office is away. The officer may not even know that there are files pending, even if they are urgent. These problems cause inordinate delays in the workflow process. A tool such as e-Administration ensures prompt disposal of files and access to a central database, where the status of files can be monitored at every stage, thus ensuring efficiency and transparency.

Sudeep Jain, MD, ELCOT confirms that the implementation of the electronic system has brought down the average file approval cycle to five to seven days. Earlier on, the process took 15 to 21 days.

Source: 'E-ADMINISTRATION THE KEY FOR E-GOVERNANCE - INITIATIVES FOR CREATING A PAPERLESS OFFICE', by Sudeep Jain, IAS, Managing Director, ELCOT, Chennai-35, presented at the 7th National e-Gov Conference in Nov 2003, conducted by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pension, Govt. of India.